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ECA Curriculum

The ECA Curriculum provides the theoretical and methodological framework of the Emotion–Cognition–Action approach, developed primarily for lower primary education. It describes how emotions, cognitive learning and practical action can be consciously connected in the learning process. The curriculum presents the pedagogical principles of ECA, its objectives, target groups, learning areas and expected development of competences. It supports teachers in creating learning situations that combine emotional engagement, thinking, creativity, choice, cooperation, reflection and real-life action. The curriculum serves as the conceptual foundation for the ECA Teacher Handbook, training programme and practical learning materials developed within the project. It is available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

ECA Teachers’ Handbook

The ECA Teacher Handbook is a practical guide for lower primary teachers who want to apply the Emotion–Cognition–Action approach in everyday school practice. It shows how ECA elements can be introduced gradually, without requiring a complete transformation of teaching practice at once. The Handbook addresses the changing role of the teacher towards facilitation, the practical integration of Emotion–Cognition–Action, science and ecological learning, individualised and differentiated learning, and approaches to assessment. Particular attention is given to teacher self-reflection and to increasing student autonomy, choice and responsibility for learning. The Handbook combines methodological guidance with reflection questions, practical examples, teaching tools and lesson plans, supporting educators in adapting ECA to their own learners and learning environments. It is available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

ECA Teacher Traning Plan

The ECA Teacher Training Plan is a five-day, 30-hour professional development programme for educators, trainers and learning facilitators. It combines Social Emotional Learning, Character Strengths, Emotional Intelligence, Multiple Intelligences and experiential learning within the ECA framework. The training focuses on creating safe and engaging learning environments, understanding learner diversity and individual strengths, inclusion, learning through experience and the practical design of ECA activities. A distinctive element is urban exploration, using the city as a living classroom. The programme combines theory, practical activities, discussion, active learning and reflection. The guide provides a complete programme structure with 14 modules, activities and

resources that can be used to deliver the training. The Training Plan is available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

50 practical ECA activities

The ECA Practical Activity Collection is a flexible toolkit containing 50 practical materials: 40 lesson plans, 4 worksheets, 3 homework activities and 3 project outlines. The activities are designed primarily for lower primary education and connect the three elements of the ECA approach: Emotion, Cognition and Action. Science and ecological topics are explored through personal experience and emotional engagement, questioning, observation, comparison, measurement, thinking and concrete action. The collection includes garden and outdoor learning, nature in the classroom, ecological topics and skill-building activities. It is not intended as a fixed teaching sequence: educators can select and adapt the materials to different topics, age groups, learners and educational contexts. The collection is available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

Best Practice Guidelines

The ECA Best Practice Guidelines brings together the main lessons learnt from developing, piloting, adapting and using ECA in different educational settings. They draw on experiences from classrooms, teacher training, university programmes, camps, gardens, outdoor activities and community events. The Guidelines explore what makes a learning process genuinely ECA and highlight key aspects such as learner autonomy, authentic action, choice, reflection, cooperation and the learning environment. “Postcards from practice” present concrete experiences and lessons learnt, while six common traps show what can go wrong when applying ECA and suggest practical alternatives. The Guidelines encourage educators not simply to reproduce ECA materials, but to adapt them and create meaningful ECA learning experiences in their own contexts. The Guidelines is available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

ECA Website

The ECA project website introduces the Emotion–Cognition–Action approach, the project objectives, partners and activities, and provides access to the materials and results developed during the project. Visitors can follow the project’s implementation through news and reports on training, piloting, workshops and dissemination events. The website brings together the ECA Curriculum, Teacher’s Handbook, Teacher Training Plan, Practical Activity Collection, Best Practice Guidelines and other practical resources. It also supports the continued dissemination and use of the ECA approach after the end of the project. The website is available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

ECA Cards

The ECA Cards are a set of 20 practical reflection and activity cards for educators. They translate key elements of the ECA approach into short, accessible prompts that can be used individually, in teacher training or in professional discussions. They invite educators to examine their own teaching practice, consider the learner’s perspective and explore how greater autonomy, personal involvement, reflection and meaningful action can become part of everyday learning. Short texts, visual models, questions and small tasks connect pedagogical ideas with concrete situations and encourage

experimentation and change. The cards are designed as a flexible resource rather than a fixed sequence and can be selected according to the needs of the educator or group. They are available in Hungarian, English and Polish.

Templates

The ECA Templates provide practical tools supporting all four project activities:

- Templates for planning, coordination and project monitoring, helping PM work.
- Templates supporting the piloting and evaluation of educational materials, as well as teachers' own creative eductional development work.
- Templates for organising and documenting teacher training activities.
- Templates for planning, recording and reporting implementation & dissemination activities.

Together, these adaptable tools support the practical implementation, documentation and continued use of the ECA approach.

ECA book

The ECA book brings together four major project results: the ECA Curriculum, Teacher's Handbook, Teacher Training Plan and 50 Practical Activities in a single publication. The 178-page book provides a comprehensive theoretical and practical resource for educators wishing to understand and apply the ECA approach. It was published online in Hungarian by the Meseliget Foundation (ISBN: 978-615-83278-0-0), making the methodology and teaching materials available in an integrated format.